

Hinduism Stations Activity

Mr. Flores's carousel worksheet: a Do Now plus six stations. **The blue block in each box is what goes on his paper**, sized to fit one or two ruled lines. Grey text underneath is context for you, not for copying. The questions are numbered here the way they are numbered on his sheet, so Station 3 question 2 is box 2 under Station 3. Note that page 2 of the printed sheet runs the stations out of order (6, 4, 5, 3); this key follows the station numbers instead.

DO NOW

1 How Hindus view religion

How do Hindus view religion? (complete sentence)

WRITE THIS · 21 WORDS

Hindus see religion as a way of liberating, or freeing, the soul from the illusions, disappointments and mistakes of everyday life.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The answer is sitting in the excerpt printed directly above the question, so this is a reading question rather than a memory question. The excerpt's own words are "a way of liberating (freeing) the soul from the illusions, disappointments and mistakes of everyday life." The sentence above keeps those words and makes them a full sentence, which is what the question asks for.

The same excerpt says Hinduism has no single founder and no single set of ideas, only a shared worldview. That is the setup for the question that comes back at almost every station: how is this a way of life rather than a religion you attend.

STATION 1

1 Moksha and dharma

Define: moksha. Define: dharma.

WRITE THIS · 32 WORDS

Moksha: liberation, the soul freed from the cycle of rebirth and joined with Brahman, the universal soul.
Dharma: duty, the rules and obligations attached to your caste and your stage of life.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Mr. Flores's own Hinduism and Buddhism handout writes "Moksha Liberation/Retirement" and defines Brahman as "the universal soul (the divine/God)." The word retirement comes from the Hindu stages of life, where the last stage is stepping back from work and family to concentrate on the soul.

That same handout lists Dharma and then never defines it, so the definition above is standard world history material, not his wording.

Three lookalike words all turn up on this worksheet. **Brahma** is the creator god. **Brahman** is the universal soul. **Brahmans** are the priest caste. One thing to know: on Mr. Flores's Religions Jeopardy review, Brahman is listed among the Hindu gods, so he uses the word both ways.

2 The three ways to reach moksha

List AND explain the 3 ways for a Hindu to achieve moksha.

WRITE THIS · 31 WORDS

1. Works: do your own duties and rituals well. 2. Knowledge: study and meditate until you see your soul and Brahman are one. 3. Devotion: give loving worship to a god.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

These are usually called the three paths, or margas: the way of works (karma), the way of knowledge (jnana) and the way of devotion (bhakti). The Sanskrit names are optional here. If the station board used them, he can add them in the margin.

The question says list AND explain, so each of the three needs its name plus a few words of what it means. A bare list of three words answers only half of it.

3 Hinduism as a way of life

How is Hinduism a way of life?

WRITE THIS · 34 WORDS

Hinduism is not only worship. It sets a Hindu's caste and job, what they eat, who they marry and what their duty is at each stage of life, every day from birth to death.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

This is the question the whole carousel is built around, and it returns at five more stations. The move is the same every time: point at something that looks ordinary and non religious, then show that the religion decides it.

This station wants the broad version. Each later station wants one specific example, so a different sentence each time is what the activity is after.

STATION 2

1 One god or many

Do Hindus believe in more than one god? (circle YES or NO) What is the term for this belief?

WRITE THIS · 5 WORDS

YES. The term is polytheism.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Circle YES.

Worth knowing, not worth putting on the line: many Hindus would say the thousands of gods are all forms of one universal spirit, Brahman, which is why some books describe Hinduism as one god with many faces. The worksheet gives a YES or NO circle and asks for one term, so the answer on the paper stays polytheism. The nuance belongs in the margin or in class, not in the blank.

2 The three major gods

List AND explain the 3 major Hindu gods.

WRITE THIS · 25 WORDS

Brahma, the creator, who makes the world. Vishnu, the preserver, who protects it. Shiva, the destroyer, who ends it so it can be created again.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The three together are called the Trimurti. The destroying is not treated as evil, because it clears the way for the next creation, which is why the cycle wording above is useful.

List AND explain again, so the job after each name is the half that answers the explain part.

3 Reincarnation

Define: reincarnation.

WRITE THIS · 23 WORDS

Reincarnation is the belief that after death the soul is born again in a new body, over and over, until it reaches moksha.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Mr. Flores's handout defines karma as "good deeds/bad deeds that determine rebirth," so karma and reincarnation are a pair: reincarnation is the rebirth, karma is what decides which body comes next.

One word to leave out: his handout defines Samsara as "the false world itself/the product of illusion," not as the cycle of rebirth. Plenty of books do use Samsara for the cycle, but using it that way here would contradict his own sheet.

4 Karma proves it

How does the belief in karma PROVE that Hinduism is a way of life?

WRITE THIS · 34 WORDS

Karma is earned by ordinary acts, not by worship. How a Hindu treats people at work, at home and in the street decides the next life, so every hour of a normal day counts.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Five questions on this worksheet ask the same PROVE question about different things, so five different answers are what it is testing.

The karma angle is **time**: there is no hour of the day that sits outside the religion, because the deeds that set the next life are ordinary ones. Keep that separate from the caste answer, which is about who decides your place, and from the Ganges answer, which is about physical daily needs.

1 What the caste system is

What is the caste system?

WRITE THIS · 28 WORDS

The caste system divides Hindu society into groups a person is born into: Brahmins (priests), Kshatriyas (warriors), Vaisyas (merchants) and Shudras (laborers), with the untouchables below all four.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Those four names and jobs are copied from Mr. Flores's own handout, which writes "Brahmins = Priests, Kshatriyas = Warriors, Vaisyas = Merchants, Shudras = Laborers," and lists untouchables separately below them, alongside the sadhus, the wandering monks.

Other books spell them Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Sudra. His spellings are the safe ones to hand in.

2 No social mobility

Why does the caste system NOT allow for social mobility?

WRITE THIS · 34 WORDS

A person is born into a caste and stays in it for life. It sets their job and who they can marry, and hard work or money cannot move them up. Only rebirth can.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Social mobility means moving from one level of society to another. The caste system blocks it because caste is fixed at birth and holds for the whole life: work, marriage and even who a person eats with stay inside it.

The only movement the system allows is between lives. Karma decides whether the next birth is into a higher or a lower caste, which is why the last sentence of the answer matters.

3 Caste proves it

How does following the caste system PROVE that Hinduism is a way of life?

WRITE THIS · 34 WORDS

Caste is a religious rule that picks a Hindu's job, marriage partner and who they may eat with. The whole shape of their social life comes from the religion, not from their own choice.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The caste angle is **social structure**: a religion that only ran ceremonies would have nothing to say about which job you take or who you marry. Here it says both.

Keeping this one about rank and social position is what stops it repeating the karma answer, which was about ordinary deeds counting.

1 The sacred texts

What are the SACRED TEXTS of Hinduism? (two blanks)

WRITE THIS · 6 WORDS

The Vedas and the Bhagavad Gita.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

This pair comes from Mr. Flores himself. On his Religions Jeopardy review, the holy book for Hinduism is answered as the Vedas and/or the Bhagavad Gita, so that is the wording he is looking for.

The Vedas are the oldest layer, a collection of hymns and prayers. The Bhagavad Gita is a later poem that sits inside the epic Mahabharata. Other books give the Upanishads as the second text and that is also correct, but his answer is the one that goes on the line.

2 The sacred animal

What is a sacred animal to the Hindus?

WRITE THIS · 2 WORDS

The cow.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Cows are treated as sacred and are not eaten. If the line is longer than two words, this fills it: the cow is sacred, it is protected rather than slaughtered, and many Hindus are vegetarian partly for that reason.

3 Sati

What is the Hindu practice of sati?

WRITE THIS · 25 WORDS

Sati is the old practice in which a widow died on her husband's funeral fire rather than living on without him. India has outlawed it.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Also spelled suttee. It was never universal: it was concentrated in certain regions and castes, it was banned in British India in 1829, and it is a crime in India today.

This is a heavy topic and the question only asks what it is. One plain sentence answers it and there is no need for him to add detail.

4 Sati proves it

How does the practice of sati PROVE that Hinduism is a way of life?

WRITE THIS · 32 WORDS

Sati reached inside the family. Religion decided what happened to a wife after her husband died, so belief ran marriage, the home and even death, not just what happened at a temple.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The sati angle is **the family and the home**. Caste was about a person's public place in society; sati is about what happens inside a marriage and at a death, which is why the two answers do not overlap.

A second line he can add if the space is long: a rule that extreme only makes sense if the belief is understood to cover the whole of a life.

STATION 5

1 Harijan

Define: harijan.

WRITE THIS · 26 WORDS

Harijan is the name Gandhi gave the untouchables. It means children of God, and he used it to say they were not lower than anyone else.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Gandhi coined harijan, usually translated as children of God, to replace the word untouchable.

Background if it comes up in class: many people in that community now reject harijan as condescending and use **Dalit**, meaning broken or oppressed. The worksheet asks for harijan, so harijan is what goes on the line.

2 What the 1950 Constitution changed

How did the Indian Constitution of 1950 change the status of the untouchables?

WRITE THIS · 27 WORDS

The 1950 Constitution ended untouchability and made caste discrimination illegal. Untouchables became equal citizens with the right to vote, to go to school and to enter temples.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The Constitution that took effect in 1950 abolished untouchability and banned discrimination by caste. It also reserved places in government jobs, in the legislatures and in universities.

The part worth knowing: the law changed the legal status, not the behavior. Caste discrimination carried on in practice, especially in villages, long after 1950. That gap is exactly what the next question is driving at.

3 The Constitution proves it

How does the Indian Constitution PROVE that Hinduism is a way of life?

WRITE THIS · 37 WORDS

India had to pass a national law to undo caste. A belief that lived only inside a temple would never need that. Caste had shaped jobs, schools and villages, so it took the Constitution to change it.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The Constitution angle is **scale**: the belief was wound so far into jobs, marriage, schooling and village layout that unwinding it needed the country's founding document, not a change in how people worshipped.

An alternative he can use instead: the law banned untouchability and daily life carried on much as before, which shows the religion was running society rather than sitting on top of it.

STATION 6

1 What the video shows

What is being worshipped in the video?

His to supply. Only the video at the station can answer this one. He writes down what is actually on the screen: the river itself, a particular god, or a ceremony. One or two words is enough.

Gap. The worksheet points at a video shown at Station 6, and that video is not in Mr. Flores's file. The station's other two questions are both about the Ganges River, so the video belongs to that topic, but naming what is being worshipped without seeing it would be a guess. Answer this one from the station screen, or ask Mr. Flores.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The rest of the station stands on its own, so the two questions below can be finished now and this one filled in during class in a few seconds.

2 Uses of the Ganges

How do Hindus use the Ganges River?

WRITE THIS · 35 WORDS

Hindus bathe in the Ganges to wash away sin, use its water in worship, and put the ashes of their dead into it. They also drink it, wash in it and water crops with it.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The river is treated as a goddess, Ganga, and its water as purifying. Pilgrims bathe in it at cities like Varanasi to wash away sin, and cremated ashes are placed in it so the dead move toward a better rebirth.

At the same time it is the drinking water, the washing water and the irrigation for hundreds of millions of people. Getting both halves into the answer is what sets up the next question.

3 The Ganges proves it

Hindus rely on the Ganges River for many things. How does this PROVE that Hinduism is a way of life?

WRITE THIS · 36 WORDS

The same river gives drinking water, crops and a place to wash, and it is also holy. Worship and daily chores happen in the same water, so there is no line between regular life and religion.

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The Ganges angle is **physical need**. The other answers were about deeds, social rank and the family. This one is about the holy thing and the practical thing being the same water.

That is the strongest version of the whole worksheet's argument: a person cannot separate the religion from the water they drink, so the two do not come apart.

Gap: the station boards. This key is built from Mr. Flores's own "Hinduism Carousel Activity" PDF, which gives the questions but not the readings. The reading at each station lives on the class website, which would not load. So the answers here are standard world history material, plus the vocabulary from his own Buddha Bumperstickers handout and the answers from his Religions Jeopardy review. Where a station board words something differently, the board wins.

Gap: the Station 6 video. Flagged in the box above. It is not in any file here and has not been guessed at.

Note: the two blanks at Station 4. The sheet asks for the sacred texts in two blanks but does not say which two. The pair above is taken from Mr. Flores's own Jeopardy answer for Hinduism. If the station board names a different pair, use the board.

Built from Mr. Flores's own "Hinduism Carousel Activity.pdf", which gives the questions but no answers, plus his Buddha Bumperstickers handout and his Religions Jeopardy review, which do give his own wording. Pulled 20 September 2026 and checked by a separate pass. Anything those files do not cover is standard world history material, and the notes at the end say where. The blue blocks are sized to fit a worksheet line; the grey text is context for you.